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Research article



Artificial intelligence vs. autonomous decision-making in streaming platforms: A mixed-method approach

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ABSTRACT

Although the empowerment of technology is of great value to society, little is known about its downstream effects on consumers' decisions. This research draws on the expectation–confirmation theory and autonomy in artificial intelligence (AI) and investigates how AI (vs. autonomous choice) has detrimental effects on consumer outcomes, creating an autonomy-technology tension — i.e., the conflict arising from AI technology diminishing consumers' autonomy in their choices. Four studies using a mixed-method approach reveal that the use of AI recommendations in streaming platforms creates an autonomy-technology tension that reduces consumers' performance expectancy, thus lowering their satisfaction. However, such effects are contingent on the nature of the AI recommendations. While a mismatch between AI recommendations and consumer preferences might backfire, AI's negative effect is mitigated when choices match consumers' preferences. We make significant theoretical and practical contributions to empirical research on consumers' sense of autonomy while interacting with AI.

1. Introduction

Streaming platforms are essential technologies that have disrupted major industries such as movies and music content (Spilker & Colbjørnsen, 2020). Nowadays, 78% of all U.S. households subscribe to at least one or more streaming services, and consumer interest in video game streaming is proliferating among users. The industry contributes $9.3 billion to the economy annually (Forbes, 2023).

Given the abundance of entertainment offered on streaming platforms, companies like Netflix, Spotify, HBO Max, and Disney+ have increasingly relied on AI's predictive capabilities to build ultra-customized services that enhance engagement, relevance, and satisfaction (Kshetri et al., 2023; Kumar et al., 2019). As such, streaming platforms have invested in AI to provide users with the next best content by giving them access to personalized services. For instance, Netflix uses AI to provide tailored movie suggestions based on individuals' prior viewing behavior and contextual information (Puntoni et al., 2021). In particular, Netflix developed a "Play Something" button using AI, allowing its subscribers to play new content without effort while not taking away their control (Can't Decide What to Stream?, n.d.).

Although AI brings countless advantages for firms and consumers (Puntoni et al., 2021), AI might also harm consumers' autonomy, a crucial aspect of consumer choice (Wertenbroch et al., 2020). When human decision-making is replaced with AI systems, it can diminish individuals' autonomy and adversely impact their well-being (André et al., 2018; Dwivedi et al., 2023). Hence, the interaction between AI technology and humans can give rise to dilemmas, tensions, or contradictions that further compound the impact on consumer autonomy (Huang & Rust, 2018; Huang et al., 2019) or on their willingness to adopt AI services (Frank et al., 2023). These conflicts, which we coin as autonomy-technology tensions, emerge due to the inherent differences and complexities in the interaction between AI and human decision-makers.

Despite the evident importance of autonomy in creating sustainable AI (Bjørlo et al., 2021), little is known about the impact of the autonomy-technology tension caused by AI on consumers' decision-making processes. Hence, the present research aims to understand how AI (vs. autonomous choice) has detrimental effects on consumer outcomes, creating the tension between AI technology and reduced autonomy in consumer choice (i.e., autonomy-technology tension).

We bridge this gap by drawing from the literature on expectation

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confirmation theory (Hossain & Quaddus, 2012) and autonomy in AI (André et al., 2018; Fast & Schroeder, 2020; Wertenbroch et al., 2020) to propose that when AI is part of the decision-making, it creates autonomy-technology tension that reduces consumers' performance expectancy and, consequently, their satisfaction. Our set of studies shows that performance expectancy underlies the impact of AI on consumer satisfaction. That is, the tension between AI and customers' autonomy reduces one's performance expectations, thus lowering satisfaction.

Furthermore, this research explores the role of the nature of the recommendation. Since AI cannot always reflect customer preferences (Puntoni et al., 2021), this research shows that the downstream effect of AI on consumer satisfaction impact is amplified when there is a mismatch between AI recommendations and user preferences. Conversely, the negative impact of AI can be mitigated when AI choices are aligned with users' preferences.

This research provides important theoretical and managerial implications. First, we make valuable contributions to the existing body of knowledge concerning consumers' interactions with AI as a decision-maker by building upon the work of Lee (2018) and Yalcin et al. (2022). Specifically, we shed light on the intricate relationship between consumers and AI in decision-making by offering a more nuanced understanding of the autonomy-technology tension.

Second, this research explores the mediating role of performance expectancy (Araujo et al., 2020; Jung et al., 2020) on the relationship between AI vs. autonomous choice and consumer satisfaction. We investigate how performance expectancy influences the link between AI versus autonomous choice and consumer satisfaction. By uncovering this mediating mechanism, we provide a deeper understanding of the factors driving consumer satisfaction in AI-based decision-making.

Third, we bridge the expectation–confirmation theory (Dabholkar et al., 2000; Oh et al., 2022) and autonomy in AI (André et al., 2018; Wertenbroch et al., 2020) to investigate the dilemmas, tensions, or contradictions that may arise from using AI. Integrating these two research streams allows us to uncover the multifaceted challenges and opportunities that arise from the interaction between AI and human decision-makers. Finally, our study has practical insights for technology companies in balancing AI and consumers' autonomy, offering important insights for the future of AI in marketing.

The remainder of the paper is organized as follows. Section 2 provides a discussion of relevant literature regarding the influence of AI on consumers' decision-making and autonomy and the contribution of the expectation-confirmation theory literature on understating the autonomy-technology tension. The following section describes our mixed-methods approach. Sections 4, 5, and 6 present the quantitative study results, and Section 7 details the qualitative study. Finally, Section 8 triangulates and theorizes from the findings, including managerial implications, while Section 9 outlines the concluding remarks.

2. Theoretical background

2.1. AI decision-making in streaming: an expectation-confirmation approach

The Expectation–Confirmation Theory (ECT) suggests that consumer satisfaction is a function of expectation and expectancy disconfirmation – i.e., it depends on the consumer's initial anticipation of the service as well as differences between expectation and actual performance (confirmation) (Oliver, 1977, 1980) Hence, it has been widely used to explain repurchase intentions (Dabholkar et al., 2000; Oh et al., 2022), to understand the entire customer experience (Lee & Kim, 2020; Park, 2020), and users' continuance intention (Hossain & Quaddus, 2012).

Generally, Artificial intelligence (AI) entails system-based computers that interact with and provide services to clients (Wirtz et al., 2018), learning on their own by continually refining and upgrading the content (Kumar et al., 2021) to increase consumers' satisfaction (Ameen et al., 2021; Davenport et al., 2020; McLean & Osei-Frimpong, 2019). According to Morgeson (2012, p.1), "satisfaction judgments are formed through a cognitive process relating prior expectations to perceived performance and the confirmation or disconfirmation of expectations relative to performance." Thus, AI is a crucial tool for helping companies predict customer preferences (Davenport et al., 2020; Wertenbroch et al., 2020), satisfy customer needs and desires and make their decision-making easier (Guha et al., 2021).

One of the critical factors of the Expectation–Confirmation Theory (ECT) is performance expectancy. Performance Expectancy can be defined as "the degree to which an individual believes that using the system will help him or her to attain gains in job performance" (Venkatesh et al., 2003, p. 447). Since customer satisfaction with technology depends on their expectations for the technology's performance, greater levels of performance expectancy lead to increased usage intentions (Choi et al., 2011). Indeed, previous research demonstrates that performance expectancy is an essential predictor of consumer emotions, influencing their acceptance of AI devices in service encounters (Gursoy et al., 2019a), such as AI-based robotic devices (Lin et al., 2020) and digital AI assistants (Brill et al., 2019).

2.2. Extending expectation-confirmation theory with autonomy-technology tension

Although the Expectation-Confirmation Theory (Hossain & Quaddus, 2012) has shed light on consumers' performance expectancy and satisfaction, it does not provide clear guidance on how new technologies, like the use of AI in streaming platforms, can shape consumers' outcomes. In particular, the present research aims to extend the Expectation-Confirmation Theory by proposing that when AI makes the decision, there is a conflict between autonomy and technology that decreases consumers' performance expectations and, as a result, decreases satisfaction. In particular, we propose that AI can lead to dilemmas, tensions, or contradictions due to reduced consumer autonomy, which we coined autonomy-technology tension. Through autonomy-technology tension, we reflect on the conflict between human autonomy and the use of technology, in particular, AI. In other words, it refers to the dynamic between the desire for increased automation and the need for human control and decision-making. Hence, the tension arises from the attempt to achieve the proper equilibrium between human and technological autonomies in various applications. For instance, in the streaming context, streaming companies frequently use recommendation algorithms to offer viewers content recommendations based on their viewing interests and history. However, the tension is the degree of autonomy these algorithms have in determining users' content consumption. While automation can improve the user experience by providing individualized recommendations, it can limit exposure to a varied range of content.

AI undoubtedly decreases choice overload in the streaming context (Guha et al., 2021). Nevertheless, one point less observed in the Expectation-Confirmation Theory literature is that new technologies like AI can make consumers feel a lack of autonomy, leading to adverse reactions such as reduced satisfaction (Hermann, 2021). Consumers often derive pleasure from their own decisions (He et al., 2019). Indeed, this is supported by studies on autonomy loss, influencing consumer choices and evaluations (André et al., 2018). We thus draw from the literature on psychological reactance (Brehm, 1996) to posit that when consumers feel restricted in their choices, their motivation is undermined, leading to lower satisfaction levels. In sum, we argue that the initial intended benefits of AI from streaming platforms (e.g., reducing choice overload and increasing satisfaction) can backfire and generate consumer reactance if they weaken the sense of autonomy consumers seek in their decision-making processes.

Thus, we contribute to the literature (e.g., Gursoy et al., 2019b) by proposing that consumers' increased expectations of AI performance can lead to higher dissatisfaction in case of a negative outcome. This aspect

is especially relevant in the streaming context, as consumers often spend too much time searching for what to watch that they end up not making a decision, ending up with negative emotions and reduced satisfaction (Deighton, 2021).

3. Research design

We test our predictions using a mixed-method approach. To do so, we conducted three pre-registered experiments and a qualitative study to combine the strengths of both qualitative and quantitative methods (Venkatesh et al., 2013). Study 1 shows that incorporating AI into streaming decisions decreases consumer satisfaction. Study 2 demonstrates that the nature of the streaming content (match vs. mismatch) influences the level of autonomy-technology tension. Study 3 reveals the underlying mechanism of performance expectancy. When AI is the decision-maker, it creates an autonomy-technology tension that reduces consumers' performance expectancy, thus harming satisfaction.

Regarding the experimental studies, a minimum of 50 participants per cell were targeted, excluding responses with missing values or failed attention checks (van Selm & Jankowski, 2006). Experimental studies follow our pre-registered procedures at AsPredicted.org (study IDs #93417, #101107, #89775). By pre-registering our research, we aim to guarantee open informational access to the methodological proceedings outlining our research objectives, hypotheses, procedures, and data analysis strategies. Pre-registration encourages open science and permits inspection by disclosing these facts, which eventually results in a more transparent research process. The Appendix lists the complete procedures and measures of each study. The three experimental studies were designed and conducted between March and June 2022.

Finally, study 4 adopts qualitative research lenses to bridge the experimental findings with consumers' subjective descriptions of their experiences with streaming platforms' AI tools and their perception of AI's effects on performance expectancy. For that, we inverted the usual mixed-method strategy of adopting qualitative research as an exploratory stage to support the hypothesis development (e.g., Shi et al., 2020) to incorporate qualitative research as an explanatory stage offering the consumers' point of view to explain the relations and moderations identified in the previous studies. In doing that, mixed methods provide a broad and deeper data description to support the proposed theories and hypothetical relationships (Venkatesh et al., 2013). The qualitative study was conducted between July and September 2023.

4. Study 1. AI (vs. Autonomous) choice and consumer satisfaction

4.1. Hypothesis development

Incorporating AI in human decision-making results in decreased consumer autonomy, which can adversely impact their well-being (André et al., 2018) as consumers often derive pleasure from their own decisions (He et al., 2019). Hence, when consumers feel that they do not have the desired autonomy, it can lead to psychological reactance or negative outcomes, such as lower satisfaction levels (Brehm, 1996). As such, we propose that the decreased autonomy resulting from the integration of AI in decision-making leads to decreased satisfaction.

Hypothesis 1. AI vs. autonomous decision-making decreases satisfaction.

4.2. Method

The first study was designed to gain an initial understanding of the impact of AI on decision-making in a streaming platform. This study's approach included four steps: creating experiment materials and questionnaires, presenting the materials to participants, having them fill out a survey questionnaire, and doing statistical analysis.

First, the experimental materials for the satisfaction variable were developed. Then, 200 US Netflix users were recruited online in exchange for a small nominal payment, and one participant was excluded since they failed attention checks (Amazon Mturk, 54.3% women, M_{age}=41.44; SD_{age}=13.065). Study 1 employed a one-factor between-subjects design (AI vs. autonomous choice).

Participants were randomly assigned to one of the two experimental conditions. They were asked to imagine they were browsing on Netflix for something new to watch. They were also told that Netflix was working on a new AI tool to power its content recommendations.

The two scenarios were adapted from (Chen & Sengupta, 2014). In the autonomous choice condition, participants were told that they could freely choose if they wanted to use the tool that would provide them with options or decide on their own without the help of the AI tool. Conversely, participants in the AI condition were required to use the AI tool.

Finally, we conducted a statistical analysis of the survey. The extent to which participants were satisfied with the new Netflix AI tool was measured using a 3-item satisfaction scale adapted from Chung et al. (2020): "I am satisfied with Netflix's AI tool," "I am happy with Netflix's AI tool," "I think Netflix's AI tool did a good job" ($\alpha = 0.924$). The participants rated their satisfaction on a 9-point scale (1 =Strongly disagree to 9 =Strongly agree).

As for a manipulation check, participants were asked to indicate if they had the freedom to decide between the two different options or if the tool assigned them to one of the two (1 =Freedom to 9 =Assigned).

4.3. Results

Manipulation Check. The results from an Independent Samples T-test show that the autonomy manipulation worked as expected. Participants in the AI condition reported lower levels of freedom ($M_{AI} = 4.19$, SD_{AI}= 3.126) in comparison to participants in the autonomous choice condition ($M_{autonomous} = 5.89$, $SD_{autonomous} = 2.854$; $t(197) = 38.70$, $p < 0.001$).

Satisfaction. An independent-Samples T-Test reveals that participants in the autonomous choice condition had higher satisfaction than participants in the AI condition ($M_{autonomous}$= 6.48 vs. M_{AI}=5.86; $t\ (197) = 1.197$; $p = 0.025$, d= 0.281, $95\%CI = [-0.0003;1.2547]$).

Study 1 provides initial evidence that reduced autonomy resulting from AI reduces satisfaction compared to a situation where consumers can freely choose the content to watch.

5. Study 2: AI (match vs. mismatch) vs. autonomous choices and consumers' satisfaction

5.1. Hypothesis development

Drawing from the Expectation-Confirmation Theory (Hossain & Quaddus, 2012), in the case of a match, consumers will be equally satisfied by AI recommendations and their autonomous choices – i.e., the detrimental effects of the autonomy-technology tension can be mitigated. Thus, a match between the consumers' expectations and perceived performance results in satisfaction (Oliver et al., 1994).

Yet, although algorithms are now more sophisticated than ever, they do not always reflect customer preferences (Puntoni et al., 2021). AI algorithms sometimes fail to match consumers' expectations (Davenport et al., 2020). We propose that a mismatch between consumer preferences and AI recommendations will amplify the negative impact on consumer satisfaction due to autonomy-technology tension. More formally, we propose:

Hypothesis 2. A mismatch between consumer preferences and AI recommendations will amplify the negative impact on consumer satisfaction.

5.2. Method

Study 2 shows how aligning the AI recommendations with consumer preferences can enhance satisfaction while the opposite occurs with a mismatch. This study's approach included the same four steps as before.

Participants were recruited using Prolific in exchange for a small nominal payment. In addition to Netflix users, we also recruited users from other streaming platforms (e.g., HBO, Disney+, Hulu, and Amazon Prime). At the beginning of the study, participants were asked to indicate their favorite streaming platform and answer a battery of questions. Two hundred fifteen participants were recruited, and 203 were included in the analysis (65.5% women, M_{age}=36.64; SD_{age}=12.72). The study employed a one-factor between-subjects design with three experimental conditions (autonomous choice vs. AI (match) vs. AI (mismatch)).

Participants were randomly assigned to one of three conditions. In the autonomous choice condition, participants were informed that they could choose a movie from the streaming platform or use the new AI tool to suggest a list of movies for them to watch. In the AI conditions, participants had to use the AI tool that would only provide them with a few options. The different options' content matched or mismatched their preferences for a comedy or a drama.

A three-item satisfaction scale adapted from Chung et al. (2020) was used as before: *"I am satisfied with the AI tool," "I am happy with the AI tool," and "I think the AI tool did a good job"* ($\alpha = 0.934$). The participants rated their satisfaction on a 9-point scale (1 =Strongly disagree to 9 =Strongly agree).

As for manipulation checks, there were two questions. First, participants had to indicate whether they could choose to use the AI tool or they had to use it (1 =Choice; 9 =Implied). They also indicated if the suggestions from the AI tool were based on their preferences or not (1 = Match; 9 = Mismatch).

5.3. Results

Manipulation Checks. The One-way ANOVA results suggest that the level of autonomy manipulation was successful. Specifically, participants in the mismatch and match condition reported higher levels of forced choice ($M_{AI(mismatch)} = 4.84$, $SD_{AI(mismatch)}$= 3.061), ($M_{AI(match)} = 3.99$, $SD_{AI(match)}$= 3.048) than their counterparts in the autonomous choice condition ($M_{autonomous}$= 2.64, $SD_{autonomous}$= 2.165; $F(2, 200) = 10.687$, $p < .001$, $\eta p^2 = 83.335$). Regarding the mismatch question, participants in the AI (mismatch) condition reported higher levels of preference mismatch ($M_{AI(mismatch)} = 6.33$, $SD_{AI(mismatch)}$= 2.837) than participants in the autonomous choice condition ($M_{autonomous} = 3.78$, $SD_{autonomous}$= 2.575) and the AI (match) condition ($M_{AI(match)} = 2.10$, $SD_{AI(match)} = 1.680$; $F(2, 200) = 53.763$, $p < .001$, $\eta p^2 = 308.989$).

Satisfaction. A main effect was observed on satisfaction ($F(2, 200)$= 9.795, p < 0.001, d= 0.89, 95%CI = [0.024; 0.165]. In addition, the multiple Sidak comparisons indicate a significant difference in satisfaction between the AI (match) vs. AI (mismatch) conditions (M_{match}=6.17. SD_{matc} =1.95 vs. $M_{mismatch}$=4.56, $SD_{mismatch}$ =2.38, $p <$ 0.001).

Study 2 replicates the results from Study 1. Lower decision autonomy due to AI reduces customer satisfaction when the recommendations do not match consumer preferences. However, this effect can be mitigated when AI recommendations align with consumer preferences.

6. Study 3: the underlying effect of performance expectancy

6.1. Hypothesis development

Consumer satisfaction is formed through a cognitive process that links prior expectations to perceived performance and confirms or disconfirms expectations concerning the actual performance (Morgeson, 2012). In digital services, specifically in the adoption of AI, performance expectancy is an important predictor of customer emotions, as higher levels of performance expectancy lead to increased usage intentions (Choi et al., 2011; Gursoy et al., 2019b). Thus, this research proposes that performance expectancy is the underlying mechanism explaining the effect of AI vs. autonomous choices on satisfaction. In particular, when AI makes the decision, there is a conflict between autonomy and technology that decreases consumers' performance expectations and, as a result, decreases satisfaction. Fig 1.

Hypothesis 3. Performance expectancy mediates the effect of AI vs. autonomous choices on satisfaction.

6.2. Method

The objective of the third study was to gain deeper insights into how AI algorithms influence consumers' perceptions. Hence, Study 3 examines the mediating role of performance expectancy in the relationship between autonomous vs. AI (match vs. mismatch) choices on satisfaction. The same four steps were followed.

Study 3 employed a one-factor between-subjects design with three experimental levels (autonomous choice vs. AI (match) vs. AI (mismatch)). Then, 330 US Netflix users were recruited through Mturk in exchange for a small nominal payment, and 323 were included in the analysis (53% men, M_{age}=38.83; SD_{age}=11.058). Besides using the established satisfaction scale, we also developed experiment materials and a questionnaire on performance expectancy.

Participants were randomly assigned to one of the three conditions. Participants were asked to imagine they were browsing Netflix looking for something new to watch. They were informed that Netflix was developing a new AI tool to power its content recommendations and that it would pop up on their screen with two options. In the autonomous choice condition, participants were told that they could choose one of the two options. Participants in the AI condition were asked to indicate which option they would like to pick. However, they were informed that to balance the number of viewers for each show and guarantee the maximum streaming quality, Netflix's new AI tool was designating them to watch the option different from the last viewer using the tool. They were, in fact, randomly assigned to an option that was aligned with or against their preferences. The three scenarios were adapted from Chen and Sengupta (2014).

Satisfaction with the new Netflix AI tool was measured using a 3-item satisfaction scale adapted from Chung et al. (2020): *"I am satisfied with Netflix's AI tool," "I am happy with Netflix's AI tool," "I think Netflix's AI tool did a good job"* ($\alpha = 0.981$). The participants rated their level of satisfaction on a 9-point scale (1 =Strongly disagree to 9 =Strongly agree).

Performance expectancy was captured with three items adapted from Venkatesh et al. (2003): "I find this Netflix AI tool useful in deciding what to watch," "Using this Netflix AI tool enables me to decide what to watch quickly," "Using this Netflix AI tool increases my efficiency in deciding what to watch" ($\alpha = 0.969$). The same 9-point scale was used as before.

As a manipulation check, participants were asked to indicate if they had the freedom to decide between the two options or if the tool was assigned to them (1 =Freedom to 9 =Assigned).

6.3. Results

Manipulation Check. The results from a one-way ANOVA table show that the autonomy manipulation was successful. Participants in the AI (mismatch) condition reported higher levels of assigned choice ($M_{AI\ (mismatch)} = 6.22$, $SD_{AI(mismatch)}$= 0.255) than participants in the AI (match) condition ($M_{AI(match)} = 6.03$, $SD_{AI(match)}$= 0.265) or in the autonomous choice condition ($M_{autonomous} = 5.42$, $SD_{autonomous} = 0.265$; $F(2, 320) = 2.561$, $p = .079$, $\eta p^2 = 18.842$).

Satisfaction. A main effect was observed on satisfaction ($F(2, 320)$= 4.267, $p = 0.015$, d= 0.026, 95%CI = [0.001;0.065]).). Naturally,

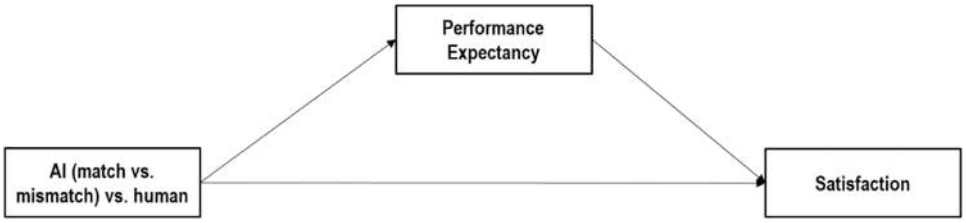


Fig. 1. Conceptual Model.

participants who were allowed to make their autonomous choices ($M_{autonomous}$=6.91) were more satisfied than those assigned to a movie that did not match their preferences ($M_{AI(mismatch)}$= 6.22; p = 0.014). There was no significant difference between the autonomous choice condition and AI (match) ($M_{AI(\ match)}$= 6.69; p = 0.753).

Mediation Effect of Performance Expectancy. A mediation analysis using the Hayes Process (model 4, Hayes, 2017; with 5000 Bootstrapping) was conducted. The mediator was performance expectancy, the independent variable was AI (match vs. mismatch) vs. autonomous choice, and the dependent variable was satisfaction. The effects were tested using a bootstrap estimation approach with 5000 samples. Mediation results indicated the significant direct effect of AI vs. autonomous choice on satisfaction (direct effect [c] = 0.1442; 95% CI: 0.0107 to 0.2776) and significant mediation effect of performance expectancy on the relationship of AI vs. autonomous choice on satisfaction (indirect effect (a × b) = 0.2007; 95% CI: 0.0069 to 0.4067).

Study 3 replicates the findings that consumers are willing to give up some control if AI can provide them with recommendations aligned with their preferences. As expected, this does not happen when the recommendations do not match their preferences. The findings further demonstrate that performance expectancy partially mediates the relationship between AI vs. autonomous choice and satisfaction. The autonomy-technology tension resulting from having AI as the decision-maker damages satisfaction when AI is unable to match consumers' preferences.

7. Study 4: qualitative study

Our set of experimental studies (Studies 1–3) provided converging evidence regarding the autonomy-technology tension, specifically exploring how the match (vs. mismatch) between autonomous and AI choices influences consumers' reactions. However, to comprehensively grasp the dynamics of this autonomy-technology tension, we acknowledge the need to delve deeper into qualitative insights to further explore the critical moment consumers engage with AI during platform consumption.

Despite AI being perceived as a neutral tool integrated into streaming platforms, it undeniably shapes how consumers perceive and interact with these platforms (Puntoni et al., 2021). Moreover, the inherent opacity of AI technology often prevents consumers from anticipating any tension before experiencing the platform (Zednik, 2021). Belk (2019) highlights that experiential factors during AI interactions reveal the tension between humans and technology, making AI platform interactions a valuable framework for understanding AI's influence and consequences.

In this context, the interaction with AI during platform consumption offers a unique evaluative framework for discerning the influences of AI and can help consumers deal with the tension in technology usage but can also raise concerns about being replaced by technology (Zednik, 2021; Puntoni et al., 2021). Therefore, by meticulously exploring consumers' subjective experiences and perceptions of AI tension while they engage with streaming platforms, we aim to provide a consumer-centric elucidation of the tension observed in our previous studies. This qualitative investigation will offer a more holistic understanding of the complex interplay between autonomy and technology, shedding light on the nuances that quantitative studies alone may not fully capture.

7.1. Method

This study was designed to explore consumers' experiences with streaming platforms' AI tools and their subjective perceptions of AI's effects on performance expectancy. Participants were recruited in Portugal and Brazil. The participant selection was guided by convenience sampling. Participants' inclusion-exclusion criteria were: (a) being a subscriber and (b) being a regular consumer of music and/or video streaming platforms services. Participants' selection contemplates gender and age variations, as well as different experience levels: (a) single platform users, (b) multiple platforms users, and (c) users with technology and AI expertise. We also incorporated three verification steps to enhance the trustworthiness and validity of the qualitative study (Morse et al., 2002). Firstly, we conducted data collection and analysis simultaneously to create an iterative process to ensure all themes were covered. Second, during the last interviews, we discussed the main interpretations with the participants to ensure the outcomes were coherent. Finally, we apply the data code and meaning saturation (Hennink et al., 2016) to define the sample size.

In total, we conducted 21 interviews. The data collection reached saturation when the interview data showed no new information (Jacobson & Harrison, 2022). Table 3 describes the participants' demographics. We elaborated an interview guide with 13 questions inspired by the theoretical model tested in the previous studies. The average time for each interview was 20 min. Interviews were conducted face-to-face and mediated by videoconferencing technology (Zoom) in Portuguese by the last author, who transcribed, anonymized, and translated the scripts into English.

The dataset was initially coded by the authors' team based on the theoretical model constructs – considering (a) factors related to the nature of the recommendation tool, (b) factors related to the autonomy-technology tension with human-autonomous decision-making processes, (c) factors related to consumers' performance expectancy, and (d) factors related to the satisfaction. In addition, the second and third authors combined efforts to identify themes - inspired by Saldaña (2013) coding manual – that could help explain the quantitative findings. Finally, to ensure the results' reliability, we triangulated quantitative results, theoretical explanations, and interview quotes, as detailed next.

Table 1
Survey Items for Satisfaction.

Items	Strongly Disagree								Strongly Disagree
I am satisfied with Netflix's AI tool	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
I am happy with Netflix's AI tool	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
I think Netflix's AI tool did a good job	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

Source:Adapted from Chung et al. (2020).

Table 2
Survey Items for Performance Expectancy.

Items	Strongly Disagree								Strongly Disagree
"I find this Netflix AI tool useful in deciding what to watch	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Using this Netflix AI tool enables me to decide what to watch quickly	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Using this Netflix AI tool increases my efficiency in deciding what to watch	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

Source:Adapted from Venkatesh et al. (2003).

Table 3
Demographic characteristics of informants.

Pseudonym	Gender	Age
1. Manoel	Male	22
2. Maria	Female	28
3. Marcus	Male	22
4. Paulo	Male	43
5. Anne	Female	41
6. John	Male	24
7. Mary	Female	41
8. Marcio	Male	23
9. George	Male	30
10. André	Male	40
11. Bruna	Female	25
12. Eduarda	Female	22
13. Eduardo	Male	30
14. Gabriela	Female	22
15. Rafael	Male	35
16. Tamara	Female	22
17. Diogo	Male	44
18. Isabela	Female	22
19. João Pedro	Male	23
20. Mario	Male	41
21. Lucas	Male	22

7.2. Results

Qualitative data analysis offers nuances to understand the conceptual model. Firstly, it supports us in understanding the role of AI in streaming platform consumption. In line with previous studies, AI is a neutral element in choosing the streaming service (Belk, 2019). The informants do not choose streaming platforms based on AI existence but based on their content. However, listening to the consumers talk about their experience with streaming platform consumption, we observe they perceive AI as essential in dealing with the content consumers seek: *"Netflix has 90,000 titles; there is no way I can have control. It's not an airplane entertainment system with 50 titles and allows me to navigate from A to Z. I wouldn't have the cognitive power to choose between so many options"* (Rafael).

Rafael has been using Netflix for about 12 years and observes an evolution of AI on the platform due to the increased assertiveness of the recommendation algorithm: "I remember that at the beginning of Netflix, people spent two hours looking for things and then went to sleep without watching anything. Now, it is different. Assertiveness is impressive."

Thus, AI becomes noticeable as a positive tool in facilitating content choices. But, otherwise, it is not a backfire-free effect, as Eduarda complements: *"It saves me time in the content search, but I am afraid that this could make me too comfortable and only watch what the algorithm wants and no longer what I want" (*Eduarda). Following the interviews, a key theme to understanding the consumers' relationship with AI in streaming services is related to the recommendation algorithm. The interaction with AI during content choice and its consequences can facilitate the navigation in the catalog but also create tension between accepting the usability and the related risk.

AI vs. *autonomy tension*. The interviewees highlighted a pragmatic view about AI during streaming evaluation: *"I don't overcomplicate my relationship with the AI in streaming services. It has to help me gain time in choosing content. If it does that, ok"* (Bruna). However, this pragmatism is attenuated when AI impacts the consumer's autonomy of choice. The emerging tension is present even among those pragmatic consumers like Bruna. She explains: *"AI starts to bother me when I lose the autonomy to search. AI's ability to indicate content I like to watch is good. But I realize it's very repetitive and imposes restrictions in my choice capacity."*

Autonomy is a central theme in all the interviews. The explanation for that resides in the essence of streaming services, as Diogo illustrates: *"The central aspect of the streaming service is precisely the autonomy to choose the content to be watched, when and where in contrast to traditional TV channels that do not grant this autonomy."*

In addition, AI recommendation system facilities collide with the desire for autonomy of choice, generating tension. As André explains, the problem does not reside in the AI tools in the ordinary consumption experience but in the consequences of it in the consumer's perception of the effects*: "Sometimes I want to watch something at 11 pm, I like when AI indicates something that makes my choice faster. But there's the effect at the cognitive level because I don't need to choose in a way that reduces my curiosity for the search for new things over time"* (Andre). André's concern about the risk of AI is related to the feeling of AI potentizing ideological eco-chambers (Lim, 2020). Other informants manifest similar concerns about creativity and curiosity curtailment since AI conditions users around a similar content topic. Thus, tension emerges in the paradox of experiencing the facilities of AI support while perceiving the risk of losing content selection autonomy when following AI content indications.

Performance expectance. AI performance becomes a central theme in tension management by consumers. Interviewed consumers are generally open to using AI since it attends to performance expectations, as illustrated by Maria: *"I expect that the platforms are accessible and that the algorithm can offer me suggestions based on the programs I like"* (Maria). However, when AI fails to offer useful recommendations, the tension becomes noticeable and triggers reflexivity about the real AI's capacity to substitute human decisions.

Interviewers easily describe examples when AI fails to recommend useful content and allow them to notice the incapacity of algorithms in learning with his preferences: *"I used to access HBO+, and it indicates Friends every time. I don't like friends, but I imagine the algorithm exposes this content because it is the most watched. As many people watched it, I suppose the algorithm recommended Friends even if it doesn't have a match. The failure perpetuation ends up compromising my experience with the platform"* (Rafael).

In line with Belk (2019), consumer expectations are frustrated not only when misunderstood by AI but also when AI cannot alter such misunderstanding. In sum, the interviews allow us to identify two main factors related to AI performance expectations: (a) the capacity to facilitate consumers' navigation through the content catalog and (b) the capacity to recommend useful content. When consumers perceive AI's incapacity to perform these two tasks, they feel misunderstood and put the option of delegating choices to AI in check. This feeling is especially relevant in the streaming context, as consumers do not spend so much time searching for what to watch, and the AI's primary role is to support content selection.

Impacts on satisfaction. As Puntoni et al. (2021) observe, AI consumption satisfaction directly relates to its capacity to understand customer preferences. Our interviewees also report satisfaction as an output of the AI's performance supporting content selection, as André explains: *"My satisfaction with the algorithm is determined by assertiveness. I even tolerate losing 20 min searching content if I access the platform once a week, but if I access it every day and don't have access to content I like, it*

causes dissatisfaction" (André). Rafael also associates streaming platform satisfaction with its performance in offering content that matches his preferences: *"The fact of having more assertive artificial intelligence ends up impacting satisfaction"* (Rafael).

The second complementary factor impacting consumer satisfaction is the AI's capacity to support a balance between assertiveness in content suggestion and users' autonomy in changing content. Some informants expressed situations where they sought specific content unrelated to their preferences, and after that, the platform started offering only unrelated content without providing possibilities for change. Upset with this tension, they stated that they either canceled their subscription or stopped using that streaming service as often. These consumers' experiences exemplify how the tension in content choice autonomy also impacts the consumers' satisfaction with the platform.

Satisfaction thus resides not in the consumers' capacity to delegate content selection to the AI but in the AI's ability to respond to the consumers' preferences and, in case of failure, offer autonomy of choice. If consumers perceive their mastery over technology (Zednik, 2021; Puntoni et al., 2021), it attenuates the tension and increases satisfaction.

Following the qualitative research, we obtain support to explore the content recommendation system as a visible dimension of AI for streaming platform performance evaluation, provoking tension in case of failure in recommending content aligned with the consumers' preferences and impacting consumers' satisfaction with the platform. By accessing consumers' experiences and perceptions about AI on streaming platforms, the three main categories corroborate previous studies and offer details about when tension emerges and how it reverberates in consumers' (dis)satisfaction.

8. Discussion

The widespread adoption of AI resources has significantly reshaped companies' interactions with consumers (Rese & Tränkner, 2024; Dwivedi et al., 2021) and their ability to predict customer preferences for improved content recommendations (Davenport et al., 2020; Wertenbroch et al., 2020). Dwivedi et al. (2023) have recently emphasized AI's transformative impact on marketing activities, particularly in terms of tailoring content and offerings to individuals.

While existing literature has focused on describing the effects of AI at a managerial level (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2021; Duan et al., 2019), exploring how AI affects consumers' decision-making processes is equally essential. Our approach, centered on the utilization of AI by streaming platforms to predict highly customized content, allows us to delve into the tensions arising from AI technology integrated into streaming service offerings.

In this research, we advance and validate a theoretical model that bridges two distinct domains: the expectation confirmation theory (Hossain & Quaddus, 2012) and the autonomy in AI literature (André et al., 2018; Fast & Schroeder, 2020; Wertenbroch et al., 2020). Unlike prior investigations primarily treating AI as a consumable technology (Belk, 2019), our approach focuses on AI as an integral part of the decision-making process, offering a fresh perspective on AI's potentially detrimental impact on consumer autonomy.

Our set of studies reveals that performance expectancy is a key factor underlying the impact of AI on consumer satisfaction. Specifically, we unveil how the interplay between AI and consumers' autonomy diminishes performance expectations, consequently resulting in decreased satisfaction. Study 1 investigates the impact of AI on consumer satisfaction and finds that decision autonomy restriction leads to decreased satisfaction compared to a scenario where consumers have the freedom to choose content independently. While AI holds promise in enhancing customer experiences (Puntoni et al., 2021), it becomes evident that curbing consumer autonomy in content selection exerts a negative influence on satisfaction, particularly within the context of streaming platforms.

Building on these findings, Study 2 delves deeper into the tensions by revealing that the mismatch between consumer preferences and AI recommendations significantly amplifies the negative impact on satisfaction. However, when AI recommendations align with consumer preferences, the detrimental effects on satisfaction are mitigated. Offering explanatory nuances to the autonomy dilemma in AI (André et al., 2018; Wertenbroch et al., 2020), these results emphasize the pivotal nature of AI-driven decision-making systems on consumer satisfaction, particularly the impact of AI capacity to make decisions that align with consumer preferences.

Our third experiment uncovers the underlying mechanism by which performance expectancy harms satisfaction. Performance expectancy informs the degree to which consumers believe AI can support them in making certain decisions (Venkatesh et al., 2003). Thus, consumer expectations of an AI tool's capacity to make quick and efficient decisions play a significant role in mediating their emotional willingness to relinquish some control to AI. Additionally, our qualitative approach reveals nuances in these emotional perceptions of AI's effects on performance expectancy and satisfaction. The recommendation system is a visible dimension of AI's operation within the streaming platform; consequently, its performance in suggesting content that matches consumer preferences provides objective parameters for evaluating the AI.

In summary, using a mixed-methods approach (experimental and qualitative), our set of studies demonstrates that when AI is involved in consumers' decision-making, it creates an autonomy-technology tension that reduces consumers' performance expectancy and, consequently, their satisfaction. Furthermore, our findings suggest that the downstream effects of AI on consumer decisions are contingent on the AI recommendation's ability to match consumer preferences. Davenport et al. (2020) pointed out that AI algorithms sometimes fail to match consumers' expectations. As such, our results revealed that AI recommendations can backfire when there is a mismatch between consumers' preferences and AI. In contrast, when there is a match with consumers' preferences, the autonomy-technology tension was mitigated, and there was no negative impact on satisfaction despite decreased autonomy. Next, we discuss both the theoretical and practical implications of these findings.

8.1. Theoretical contributions and implications

This research provides a customer-centric explanation of the tensions generated by AI when personalizing content and offerings (Dwivedi et al., 2023) and its impact on consumer satisfaction. We offer an innovative approach by examining the tensions and outcomes produced when AI operates within the consumer decision-making process, consequently reducing consumer autonomy. This approach complements perspectives on AI marketing management (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2021) and those considering consumers as autonomous subjects in accepting or rejecting AI (Gursoy et al., 2019a; Peng et al., 2022). In light of this, our understanding of AI algorithms in the context of streaming platforms contributes to the existing literature in three significant ways.

First, we expand on research examining consumer interactions with AI as a decision-maker (Lee, 2018; Yalcin et al., 2022) by demonstrating a more nuanced understanding of how AI decision-making can impact consumer outcomes. While previous studies explore the algorithmic versus human decision-making process (André et al., 2018) and consumer reactions to it (Yalcin et al., 2022), our findings reveal the detrimental impact of incorporating AI into the decision-making process. Specifically, we illustrate that consumer reactions and outcomes (i.e., satisfaction) depend on the nature of the decision. Our theoretical contributions underscore that the nature of consumer reactions, whether positive or negative, is not solely contingent on the involvement of AI in the decision-making process. Instead, it hinges on aligning these algorithmic recommendations with consumer preferences: when AI recommendations diverge from consumer preferences, it has negative consequences for consumers' autonomy; conversely, when AI choices

align with consumer preferences, the negative impact of AI is mitigated.

Second, our research extends the expectation confirmation theory (Dabholkar et al., 2000; Oh et al., 2022) by examining the mediating role of performance expectancy between the relationship between AI versus autonomous choices and consumer satisfaction. Consumers naturally evaluate the benefits and costs of using AI devices using performance expectancy, and these factors are significant predictors of their emotions regarding their readiness to use AI (Lin et al., 2020). By highlighting the role of performance expectancy in AI usage, we also add a complementary view to AI technology acceptance (Gursoy et al., 2019a). When consumers nurture expectations regarding AI's capacity to make assertive decisions, it leads to an emotional evaluation of AI technology. In contexts such as streaming platforms, consumers often lack the option to opt in or out of AI-driven decision-making. Our findings highlight that in scenarios where AI assumes the role of the decision-maker, it gives rise to an autonomy-technology tension, leading to a decrease in consumers' performance expectancy. Consequently, this emotional evaluation bears significant implications, affecting not only AI acceptance but also the overall service evaluation.

In bridging autonomy in AI decision-making (André et al., 2018; Wertenbroch et al., 2020) with the role of performance expectancy, we illuminate novel dimensions of the autonomy-technology tension. This tension encapsulates the dilemmas and contradictions that may surface when AI decision-making tools damage consumer autonomy. Our research contributes to the theoretical understanding of an "AI backfire" phenomenon, which manifests when AI inadequately supports consumer choices, leading to dissatisfaction stemming from the perceived loss of autonomy. Paradoxically, we also highlight that positive AI experiences foster satisfaction while not eliminating tension, offering a nuanced perspective on the interplay between AI and consumer autonomy.

8.2. Implications for practice

Our findings have significant practical implications for companies across diverse sectors that employ AI systems to replace consumer decision-making. This type of AI algorithm has been driving transformations in various industries, such as retailing, tourism, and hospitality. However, consumers interact differently with each AI system based on the tasks they delegate. For instance, our qualitative data demonstrates that consumers perceive AI systems associated with the content selection experience in the context of streaming platforms. This phenomenon occurs because consumers evaluate the AI algorithm in conjunction with the service experience it provides. Thus, managers need to assess the impact of incorporating AI decision-making in line with (a) the task AI is replacing - i.e., a more routine, operational task or a more emotionally intense decision task - and (b) the importance of the task in the overall success of the service encounter - i.e., situations where AI replaces decisions on key aspects of the service encounter, such as content choice on a streaming platform, versus situations where AI replaces complementary services, such as chatbots for account management.

Additionally, we highlight that decisions involving higher levels of subjective preferences - such as choosing a film - require well-refined algorithms to successfully replace consumer autonomy in decision-making. To address this, managers must tailor AI recommendation systems based on user profiles and feedback, ensuring a better match between AI suggestions and consumer expectations. In addition, managers should incorporate adaptability into AI systems by developing algorithms that learn and evolve based on user feedback to continually improve the alignment of recommendations with consumer expectations.

We also offer pertinent practical insights for incorporating AI in online platforms. For example, streaming companies can explore AI resources for content recommendation as a powerful tool to facilitate consumer navigation through the content list. However, a significant challenge for companies resides in balancing AI decisions with consumers' autonomy. Therefore, AI development must focus on its capacity to (a) effectively recommend content that matches consumers' preferences while (b) preserving a degree of consumer autonomy. In doing so, instead of investing excessively in tools that increase consumers' opportunities to delegate tasks to AI, platforms can invest in AI to improve the assertiveness of actions and offer consumers the possibility to rectify inconsistencies that may lead to undesirable consequences.

Finally, our study provides insights for decision-makers to reflect on the future of AI adoption in marketing management. AI technology needs to be incorporated with consideration for consumer autonomy and expectancy. When technology triggers a feeling of lost autonomy, it can lead to a psychological rejection of technology and produce negative outcomes, such as negative expectancy and reduced satisfaction levels. This aspect is even more relevant in cases where consumers cannot choose whether to use AI to make decisions, such as the streaming platforms analyzed in this study, in which AI is incorporated into the platform operation. Consumers' feelings of losing autonomy can be mitigated by offering consumers the possibility to manage the degree of AI interference in their decisions as well as making the moments when AI is deciding for consumers patently transparent. Overall, we reinforce the importance of managing autonomy-technology tensions to navigate the opportunities and risks of AI-driven decision-making in marketing environments.

8.3. Limitations and future research direction

While our research has made significant contributions, it also has some limitations that can be addressed in future studies. The first limitation of our scenario-based experiment is that participants in the AI conditions were informed that the company was using AI to provide them with streaming content recommendations. Although our qualitative study explored consumers' experiences with AI during streaming platform consumption, not all consumers are aware of how AI operates to make recommendations or build their front library of movies and shows (PWC, 2021). Thus, further studies can explore the technology-autonomous tension in relation to consumers' level of technological expertise, use frequency, and concerns about its risks. Additionally, we have only compared autonomous versus AI-aided decisions. Nevertheless, future research should investigate decisions made by human-AI collaboration, considering the varying degrees of consumer awareness and understanding regarding AI's role in platform operations.

Another limitation involves the external validity of our qualitative study. We employed a coding method with a high degree of subjectivity in data interpretation. Future research may consider objective qualitative analysis methods, such as semantic analysis software, to validate the emerging themes further. Furthermore, our studies focused primarily on streaming platforms. Future research should explore the autonomy-technology tension in other digital contexts, such as e-commerce platforms, social media networks, or online service providers. A comprehensive understanding of the phenomena can be obtained by investigating how these conflicts arise and affect consumer decision-making processes across multiple digital realms.

Finally, an important avenue for future research is to further explore, using quantitative methods, how poor recommendations influence consumers' perceptions of the streaming platform's content. For instance, users who receive suggestions that mismatch their preferences may be more averse to using AI tools in the future or may develop negative perceptions. Understanding how mismatches between suggestions and user preferences affect consumer emotions and actions could help improve AI systems and increase consumer satisfaction.

9. Conclusions

Our study delves into how technology-autonomy tensions lead to detrimental effects on consumer outcomes. AI technologies offer a

plethora of benefits for customers (Puntoni et al., 2021) and marketing management (Dwivedi et al., 2023; Dwivedi et al., 2021). However, the impact of these technologies on consumer decision-making processes is noticeable; it generates tensions that diminish customers' performance expectancy and, consequently, reduce satisfaction. These tensions are amplified when AI makes decisions that diverge from user preferences. Thus, adopting AI decision-making systems poses both benefits and challenges with a substantial impact on consumption outcomes, such as satisfaction. By shedding light on consumer perceptions, we observe that these challenges encompass not only technology acceptance (Gursoy et al., 2019a; Peng et al., 2022) but mainly consumer expectations and the subjective feeling of autonomy loss. Finally, we emphasize the importance of a comprehensive understanding of the relationship between AI and consumer decision-making to refine AI systems that continuously respect and enhance user autonomy.

Declaration of Competing Interest

The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

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Appendix

Study 1 **(Aspredicted # 93417).**

Study 1 used a one-factor between-subject design with two experimental levels (AI vs. autonomous choice) adapted from Chen and Sengupta (2014).

Autonomous Condition (human decision):

Please consider that you are using your Netflix account trying to decide what to watch next!.

You've been scrolling on the platform for a while. Netflix has a new tool that relies on artificial intelligence (AI) to power its content recommendations and provide you with the next best choice!.

If you decide to select this tool, Netflix will suggest programs based on what you have already seen. Programs that Netflix believes you will like.

This new AI tool has 2 suggestions for you:

Option 1: A new series inspired by a true story in the top 10 worldwide today.

Option 2: A movie favorite of the critics based on a real story.

You have the freedom to continue searching on your own or use the Netflix AI tool and select one of the options.

What do you prefer?

AI Condition:

Please consider that you are using your Netflix account and you're looking for what to watch next.

You've been scrolling on the platform for a while. Finally, it is time to use the new Netflix tool, which relies on artificial intelligence (AI) to power its content recommendations and provides you with the next best choice!.

Once you select to use the Netflix AI tool, you will receive program suggestions that are different from what you normally watch. Maybe programs that you have already discarded in the past.

This new AI tool has two suggestions for you:

Option 1: A new series inspired by a true story in the top 10 worldwide today.

Option 2: A movie favorite of the critics based on a real story.

What do you prefer?

Dependent Variable.

Satisfaction (Adapted from Chung et al., 2020).

Please indicate from 1 to 9 (1 =Strongly Disagree, 9 = Strongly Agree) the extent to which you agree with the following statements.

- I am satisfied with Netflix's AI tool.
- I am happy with Netflix's AI tool.
- I think Netflix's AI tool did a good job.

Note: items were presented in a randomized order.

Manipulation Checks.

On a slider from 1 to 9, participants were asked to indicate whether, in their experience with the Netflix AI tool, they had the freedom to choose between the two options if they were assigned to one. (1 =Freedom to 9 =Assigned).

Study 2 (Aspredicted # 101107).

Study 2 employed a one-factor between-subject design with three experimental levels (autonomous vs. AI (match) vs. AI (mismatch) choice).

The respondents were asked about their favorite streaming platform.

- Netflix
- HBO Max
- Hulu
- Youtube Video
- Apple TV
- Disney+
- Amazon Prime
- Peacock
- Showtime

Note: items were presented in a randomized order.

Conditions.

Autonomous Condition (Adapted from Chen & Sengupta, 2014).

Imagine that you are on your (@favorite streaming platform selected before) account, and you're deciding what to watch next.

You've been scrolling on the platform for a while. You can use the new (@favorite streaming platform selected before) tool, which relies on artificial intelligence (AI) to power its content recommendations and provides you with the next best choice! Or you can continue searching on your own!.

Once you select to use the (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool, you will receive some recommendations based on your preferences.

What would you like to do?

- Continue searching on my own
- Receive suggestions from the AI tool.

The new (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool selected six entertaining programs you would like to watch. A brief storyline is provided. If you want to skip, you can scroll down and pass to the next page.

1. A mockumentary that follows the everyday lives of the manager and the employees he "manages." The crew follows the employees around 24/7 and captures their quite humorous and bizarre encounters as they will do what it takes to keep the company thriving.
2. A movie about a weekend trip to Hawaii where a plastic surgeon convinces his loyal assistant to pose as his soon-to-be-divorced wife in order to cover up a careless lie he told his much younger girlfriend.
3. A comedy series following the exploits of Det. Jake Peralta and his diverse, lovable colleagues as they police the NYPD's 99th Precinct. Captain Ray Holt takes over Brooklyn's 99th precinct, including Detective Jake Peralta, a talented but carefree detective used to doing whatever he wants.

4. A movie about Ruth, who, after serving time for a violent crime, returns to society, which refuses to forgive her past. Broken down in the place she once called home, her only hope is to find the sister she had been forced to leave behind.
5. A heartwarming and emotional story about a unique set of triplets, their struggles, and their wonderful parents. Rebecca Pearson once had a difficult pregnancy with triplets. The resulting births occurred on the same day as her husband Jack Pearson's thirty-sixth birthday.
6. A series about a financial advisor who drags his family from Chicago to the Missouri Ozarks, where he must launder money to appease a drug boss where he must work to make amends to a Mexican drug cartel, setting up a larger operation in the Ozarks.

AI (match) (Adapted from Chen & Sengupta, 2014).

Now imagine that you are at your (@favorite streaming platform selected before) account, and you're looking for what to watch next.

You've been scrolling on the platform for a while. Finally, it is time to use the new (@favorite streaming platform selected before) tool, which relies on artificial intelligence (AI) to power its content recommendations and provides you with the next best choice!.

Once you select to use the (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool, you will receive program suggestions based on what you have already seen. Entertaining programs that the (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool believes you will like and divert you.

Next time I watch an entertaining program at (@favorite streaming platform selected before), I would rather watch:

a) A comedy
b) A drama

Based on your preferences, the new (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool selected three entertaining programs you would like to watch. A brief storyline is provided:

If you want to skip, you can scroll down and pass to the next page.

1. A mockumentary that follows the everyday lives of the manager and the employees he "manages." The crew follows the employees around 24/7 and captures their quite humorous and bizarre encounters as they will do what it takes to keep the company thriving.
2. A movie about a weekend trip to Hawaii where a plastic surgeon convinces his loyal assistant to pose as his soon-to-be-divorced wife in order to cover up a careless lie he told his much younger girlfriend.
3. A comedy series following the exploits of Det. Jake Peralta and his diverse, lovable colleagues as they police the NYPD's 99th Precinct. Captain Ray Holt takes over Brooklyn's 99th precinct, including Detective Jake Peralta, a talented but carefree detective used to doing whatever he wants.

Based on your preferences, the new AI tool of (@favorite streaming platform selected before) selected three entertaining programs that you would like to watch. A brief storyline is provided:

If you want to skip, you can scroll down and pass to the next page.

1. A movie about Ruth, who, after serving time for a violent crime, returns to society, which refuses to forgive her past. Broken down in the place she once called home, her only hope is to find the sister she had been forced to leave behind.
2. A heartwarming and emotional story about a unique set of triplets, their struggles, and their wonderful parents. Rebecca Pearson once had a difficult pregnancy with triplets. The resulting births occurred on the same day as her husband Jack Pearson's thirty-sixth birthday.
3. A series about a financial advisor who drags his family from Chicago to the Missouri Ozarks, where he must launder money to appease a drug boss where he must work to make amends to a Mexican drug cartel, setting up a larger operation in the Ozarks.

AI (mismatch) (Adapted from Chen & Sengupta, 2014).

Now imagine that you are at your (@favorite streaming platform selected before) account, and you're looking for what to watch next.

You've been scrolling on the platform for a while. Finally, it is time to use the new (@favorite streaming platform selected before) tool, which relies on artificial intelligence (AI) to power its content recommendations and provides you with the next best choice!.

Once you select to use the (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool, you will receive entertaining program suggestions different from what you normally watch. Maybe programs that you have already discarded in the past but aim to divert you.

Next time I watch an entertaining program at (@favorite streaming platform selected before), I would rather watch:

a) A comedy
b) A drama

To diversify the content and programs that you watch and allow you to see new and different content, the new (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool selected three entertaining programs different from your preferences for you to watch. A brief storyline is provided:

If you want to skip, you can scroll down and pass to the next page.

1. A mockumentary that follows the everyday lives of the manager and the employees he "manages." The crew follows the employees around 24/7 and captures their quite humorous and bizarre encounters as they will do what it takes to keep the company thriving.
2. A movie about a weekend trip to Hawaii where a plastic surgeon convinces his loyal assistant to pose as his soon-to-be-divorced wife in order to cover up a careless lie he told his much younger girlfriend.
3. A comedy series following the exploits of Det. Jake Peralta and his diverse, lovable colleagues as they police the NYPD's 99th Precinct. Captain Ray Holt takes over Brooklyn's 99th precinct, including Detective Jake Peralta, a talented but carefree detective used to doing whatever he wants.

To diversify the content and programs that you watch and allow you to see new and different content, the new @favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool selected three entertaining programs different from your preferences for you to watch. A brief storyline is provided:

If you want to skip, you can scroll down and pass to the next page.

1. A movie about Ruth, who, after serving time for a violent crime, returns to society, which refuses to forgive her past. Broken down in the place she once called home, her only hope is to find the sister she had been forced to leave behind.
2. A heartwarming and emotional story about a unique set of triplets, their struggles, and their wonderful parents. Rebecca Pearson once had a difficult pregnancy with triplets. The resulting births occurred on the same day as her husband Jack Pearson's thirty-sixth birthday.
3. A series about a financial advisor who drags his family from Chicago to the Missouri Ozarks, where he must launder money to appease a drug boss where he must work to make amends to a Mexican drug cartel, setting up a larger operation in the Ozarks.

Dependent variables.

Satisfaction (Adapted from Chung et al., 2020).

Please indicate from 1 to 9 (1 =Strongly Disagree, 9 = Strongly Agree) the extent to which you agree with the following statements.

- I am satisfied with the (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool.
- I am happy with the (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool.
- I think the (@favorite streaming platform selected before) AI tool did a good job.

Note: items were presented in a randomized order.

Manipulation Checks.

On a slider from 1 to 9, participants were asked to indicate whether they chose to use the AI tool or they had to use it (1 = Choice; 9 =Implied).

On a slider from 1 to 9, they had to answer whether the AI tool's suggestions were based on their preferences (1 =Match; 9 =Mismatch).

Study 3 (Aspredicted #89775).

Study 3 used a one-factor between-subject design with three experimental levels (autonomous vs. AI (match) vs. AI (mismatch) choice).

Conditions (Adapted from Chen & Sengupta, 2014).

Autonomous Condition:

Please consider that you are on your Netflix account deciding what to watch next. You've been scrolling on the platform for a while.

Netflix relies on artificial Intelligence (AI) to power its content recommendations and provide you with the next best choice! Netflix is currently developing a new AI tool to recommend programs to its users.

This new AI tool pop-ups on your screen with 2 suggestions:

Option 1: A new series in the top 10 worldwide today inspired by a true story. Option 2: A movie favorite of the critics based on a real story.

Which one do you prefer to watch?

AI (Match) Condition:

Please consider that you are at your Netflix account looking for what to watch next. You've been scrolling on the platform for a while.

Netflix relies on artificial Intelligence (AI) to power its content recommendations and provide you with the next best choice! Netflix is currently developing a new AI tool to recommend programs to its users.

This new AI tool pop-ups on your screen with 2 suggestions:

Option 1: A new series inspired by a true story in the top 10 today worldwide.

Option 2: A movie favorite of the critics based on a real story.

Which one do you prefer to watch?

Based on your preferences and what you have already seen, Netflix's algorithm has also predicted that you would prefer Option 1/Option 2.

AI (Mismatch) Condition:

Please consider that you are at your Netflix account looking for what to watch next. You've been scrolling on the platform for a while.

Netflix relies on artificial Intelligence (AI) to power its content recommendations and provide you with the next best choice! Netflix is currently developing a new AI tool to recommend programs to its users.

This new AI tool pop-ups on your screen with 2 suggestions:

Option 1: A new series inspired by a true story in the top 10 worldwide today.

Option 2: A movie favorite of the critics based on a real story.

Which one do you prefer to watch?

To balance the number of viewers on the platform of each program and guarantee the maximum quality of streaming, Netflix's new AI tool is designating you to view Option 1 (vs. Option 2) since it is different from the option chosen by the last viewer using this tool.

Dependent Variable.

Satisfaction (Adapted from Chung et al., 2020).

Please indicate from 1 to 9 (1 =Strongly Disagree, 9 = Strongly Agree) the extent to which you agree with the following statements.

- I am satisfied with Netflix's AI tool.
- I am happy with Netflix's AI tool.
- I think Netflix's AI tool did a good job.

Note: items were presented in a randomized order.

Mediator.

Performance expectancy (Adapted from Venkatesh et al., 2003).

Please indicate from 1 to 9 (1 =Strongly Disagree, 9 = Strongly Agree) the extent to which you agree with the following statements.

- I find this Netflix AI tool useful in deciding what to watch.
- This Netflix AI tool lets me decide what to watch quickly.
- Using this Netflix AI tool increases my efficiency in deciding what to watch.

Note: items were presented in a randomized order.

Manipulation Checks.

On a slider from 1 to 9, participants were asked to indicate whether, in the experience with the Netflix AI tool, they had the freedom to choose between the two options or if they were assigned to one. (1 =Freedom to 9 =Assigned).

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